concentrate on what is in your hands, which means continuing to save with a clear savings plan and to invest with proper diversification. Have financial goals for the short, medium and long term, with an investment strategy for each. Depending on your stage in life and financial goals, you will have some savings and investments. Make a start by reviewing your existing financial progress.

FINANCIAL REVIEW

Having a financial plan is no longer a one-time exercise. There are far too many variables affecting your finances for you to afford not to revisit your plans at least once a year, and sometimes more. For those who think managing money is about paying bills on time or sticking to a budget, think again. Financial planning is about understanding the full picture of your financial life and making choices that set you up for success. Think of a financial plan as the roadmap, and the review as the periodic health check-up that you undergo.

It is a comprehensive look at everything that impacts your financial well-being: income, expenses, savings, investments, debts and even insurance coverage. A solid financial review with an expert will help you recalibrate where you are today and where you want to go by examining your current spending and saving habits to establish the baseline for your plan.

HOUSEHOLD BUDGET

Start by re-categorising your budget to know where the money is going. If your income has gone down, you will not be able to budget your money the same way that you have been doing for a long time. There are several expense-tracking tools, including insights from your bank account in their app, which can help you get a sense of your spending.

Having a budget is crucial for a smooth financial journey. Once you allocate your expenses across heads, you will be able to see where you are spending more and where you have scope to cut down. A blanket cut in expenses is only a temporary fix. Revisit your budget every month to refine it, identify essential expenditures, and regularly cut all other expenses where there is room to do so.

BUDGET TRACKER

If you are experienced with your finances, you could categorise your expenses under three buckets: must-haves, need-to-haves and nice-to-haves

FIXED EXPENSES: Start making a list of the expenses that are the same amount every month. These are also the most critical payments, such as housing, utilities, food and insurance

VARIABLE EXPENSES: These are expenses whose amounts vary from month to month. Items such as clothing, hobbies, entertainment, personal care, shopping and recreation fall under this category

ANNUAL EXPENSES: Taxes and insurance premiums are included in this category

REVISIT FINANCIAL GOALS

Revisiting your financial goals during times of uncertainty is all about regaining a sense of control. It is a moment to prioritise goals in light of changes to your financial situation. You can reinforce your emergency fund, try to pay off high-interest debt and re-assess your risk tolerance. By undertaking this exercise, you will know how far you have progressed in achieving each financial goal, such as retirement, a child's education or even home loan repayment. By revisiting your financial goals, you can adjust expected investment returns, factor in inflation changes,